

it upon *thy* shoulders, and carry *it* forth in the twilight: thou shalt cover thy face, that thou see not the ground: for I have set thee *for* a sign unto the house of Israel. And I ⁷ did so as I was commanded: I brought forth my stuff by day, as stuff for captivity, and in the even I digged through the wall with mine hand; I brought *it* forth in the twilight, and I bare *it* upon *my* shoulder in their sight.

And in the morning came the word of the LORD unto me, ⁸ saying, Son of man, hath not the house of Israel, the rebellious house, said unto thee, What doest thou? Say thou ¹⁰ unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; This burden *concerneth* the prince in Jerusalem, and all the house of Israel

bearing on his shoulder the bundle of articles he carried with him in his flight.

in the twilight] in the **darkness**. So *v.* 7. The word again only Gen. xv. 17.

cover thy face] This might be to disguise himself, but the next words "thou shalt not see the land" (ground) seem to require a different sense. Cf. *vv.* 12, 13.

a sign unto...Israel] A typical sign, as explained *v.* 11, "As I have done so shall it be done unto them." Comp. ch. xxiv. 24, 27; Is. viii. 18; xx. 3; Zech. iii. 8.

⁷. *with mine hand*] lit. *with hand*, i.e. by force, Is. xxviii. 2. LXX. omits.

in the twilight] the **darkness**, as *v.* 6, so *v.* 12.

vv. 8—16. Exposition of the symbol.

The action of the prophet is a representation of what shall happen in the last days of the siege. The king and those about him shall prepare for flight; they shall go out secretly through the walls, but shall be captured and brought to Babylon.

⁸, ⁹. *in the morning*] This circumstance might seem to imply that the prophet really performed the actions described. But though in this case performance of the action was not an impossibility it was probably only narrated (see on ch. iv.). The natural sequel of the action (supposing it done), the curiosity of the people, is described, just as the action itself was, as if it had literally been shewn.

¹⁰, ¹¹. The general meaning of these verses is clear enough—the prophet's action is a representation of what shall happen in Jerusalem in the case of prince and people, but *v.* 10 is very obscure, and probably not in its original form.

This burden concerneth the prince] lit. *the prince* (is) *this burden* in Jerusalem. The term "burden" has also the sense of "oracle," but Ez. does not use it in this sense and there is no reason to find any play upon the word as Jer. xxiii. 33. The allusion can only be to the last words of *v.* 7—I bare *it* upon my shoulder; and the meaning would be: this bearing or loading has reference to the prince (*v.* 12). With this